

Privacy Policy

Last updated: June 2026

PingConnect ("we", "us", or "our") is a location-based social app that helps people connect with others nearby for casual meetups. This Privacy Policy explains what information we collect, how we use it, and your rights regarding your data.

1. Information We Collect

- **Account information:** Your name and email address, collected when you sign in via Apple.
- **Profile information:** Display name, profile photo, age, gender, and interests that you choose to provide.
- **Location data:** Your approximate location is used to show you nearby pings and to show other users that you are nearby. Location is only accessed while you are using the app or have granted background location permission.
- **Content you create:** Pings (meetup posts), messages sent in ping chats and direct messages, and check-in status updates.
- **Device information:** A push notification token so we can send you alerts about ping activity.

2. How We Use Your Information

- To match you with nearby pings and other users
- To enable in-app messaging between ping participants
- To send push notifications about ping activity (joins, acceptances, cancellations)
- To provide safety features including check-ins and trusted contact alerts
- To display your profile to other users in connection with pings you host or join

We do not send marketing emails. We do not use your data for advertising.

3. How We Share Your Information

We do not sell your personal information. We share data only with the following service providers who help us operate the app:

- **Supabase** – database and authentication infrastructure (data stored in the EU/US)
- **Expo (Expo Push Notifications)** – delivery of push notifications to your device
- **Apple** – sign-in authentication via Sign in with Apple

Your profile information (name and photo) is visible to other PingConnect users in connection with pings you participate in.

4. Location Data

PingConnect uses your device location to find pings near you and to show other users that you are in the area. Your precise location is never shared publicly — other users see only an approximate area. If you have granted background location permission, your location may be updated while the app is not in the foreground so that you continue to receive relevant nearby pings.

You can revoke location permission at any time in your device settings.

5. Data Retention

We retain your account data for as long as your account is active. You can request deletion of your account and all associated data at any time (see Section 7 below). Messages and ping content may be retained in anonymised or aggregated form for safety and moderation purposes.

6. Children's Privacy

PingConnect is intended for users aged 18 and over. We do not knowingly collect personal information from anyone under 18. If you believe a minor has created an account, please contact us and we will remove it promptly.

7. Your Rights & Account Deletion

You have the right to access, correct, or delete your personal information at any time. To delete your account and all associated data, go to **Profile** → **Settings** → **Delete Account** within the app, or email us at jacobpwinn@gmail.com and we will process your request within 30 days.

As a New Zealand user you have rights under the Privacy Act 2020, including the right to access information we hold about you and to request correction of that information.

8. Security

We use industry-standard security measures including encrypted connections (HTTPS) and secure credential storage. No method of transmission over the internet is 100% secure, and we cannot guarantee absolute security.

9. Changes to This Policy

We may update this policy from time to time. We will notify you of significant changes via a push notification or in-app message. Continued use of the app after changes constitutes acceptance of the updated policy.

10. Contact Us

If you have any questions about this Privacy Policy or how we handle your data, please contact us at:
jacobpwinn@gmail.com